

# ADVANCING AI SAFETY TOGETHER

Join the movement toward a safer, more ethical AI ecosystem in the UAE. Partner with us for enterprise training, model audits, and governance frameworks.

DIGITAL PRESENCE

[aisafety.ae](https://aisafety.ae)

CONTACT US

info@aisafety.ae

PROFESSIONAL NETWORK

LinkedIn /aisafetyuae

COMMUNITY

Instagram @aisafetyuae





# ADVANCING AI SAFETY TOGETHER

Enterprise Training, Model Auditing, and Governance  
Frameworks for a Secure AI Future in the UAE.

ESTABLISHING SAFETY & TRUST IN AI

[aisafety.ae](https://aisafety.ae)

[info@aisafety.ae](mailto:info@aisafety.ae)



## LEADERSHIP & ADVISORS:

### CO-FOUNDERS



**WES EZZEDDINE**

**Co-Founder**

AI safety specialist and fintech leader with 15+ years in tech.



**NAIYARAH HUSSAIN**

**Co-Founder**

Senior engineer in AI safety and reliability with leadership roles at IBM.

### STRATEGIC ADVISORS



**GRACE S. THOMSON**

**Advisor — AI Policy & Strategy**

Global experience across Middle East, Europe, and USA.



**MOHAMED YASSER**

**Advisor — Software Architecture**

19+ years designing solutions for government organizations.

## WORKING GROUP LEADERS:

**WES EZZEDDINE**

AI Safety Literacy

Building AI safety literacy through study groups, certifications, and expert-led policy programs.

[aisafety.ae](https://aisafety.ae)**MAIYARAH HUSSAIN**

Convening &amp; Coordination

Connecting UAE talent to global AI safety opportunities through partnerships and civil society advocacy.

[info@aisafety.ae](mailto:info@aisafety.ae)**NIKITHA ANN MATHEW**

Governance &amp; Regulation WG

Leading policy research, stakeholder roundtables, and regulatory frameworks.

**OMAR ABDULLAH**

Technology &amp; Security WG

Building AI safety tools, mentoring builders, and advancing technical standards.

## VOLUNTEERS:

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FATMA EGAL



YUSRA KHAN

# OUR MISSION AND STRATEGIC VISION:

## WHO ARE WE

**AI Safety UAE** is the UAE's first independent initiative dedicated to safe, secure, and beneficial AI development bridging the gap between technical auditing and national AI policy.

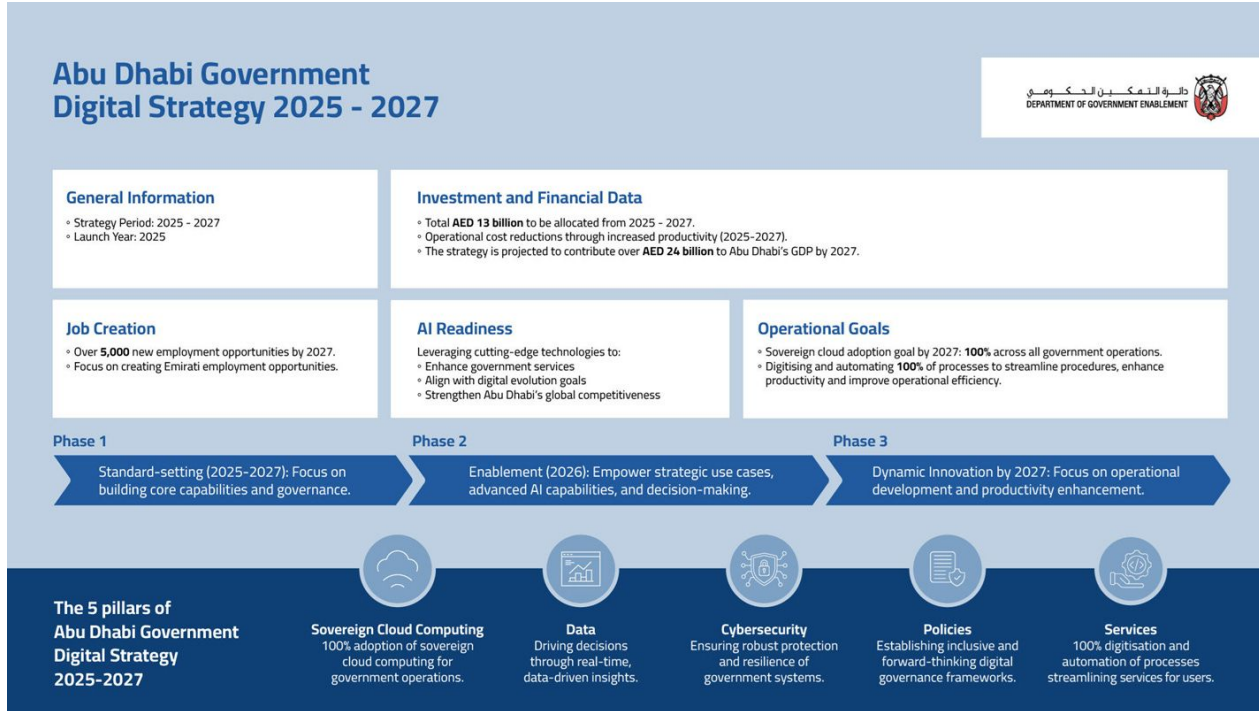
## OUR MISSION

To empower organizations with world-class enterprise training, technical model audits, and comprehensive governance frameworks that align with national interests.

## OUR VISION

Building a secure and ethical AI ecosystem that serves as the foundation for sustainable national growth. Aligning the UAE's rapid AI development with global safety standards and the UAE **AI Strategy 2031**.

**ALIGNED WITH UAE NATIONAL STRATEGY**



(Image credit: Abu Dhabi (DGE))



(Image credit: WAM)

# THE IMPERATIVE FOR AI SAFETY:

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As the United Arab Emirates continues to lead global AI innovation, the need for model reliability and ethical alignment has become a critical business imperative.

**AI Safety UAE** de-risks AI adoption for organisations in the UAE through practical governance frameworks and technical audits, ensuring that the UAE's AI growth remains both ambitious and safe.

## CRITICAL RISKS TO MITIGATE

- Data Leakage & Privacy Violations
- Sophisticated Adversarial Attacks
- Regulatory Non-Compliance
- Unchecked Model Hallucinations

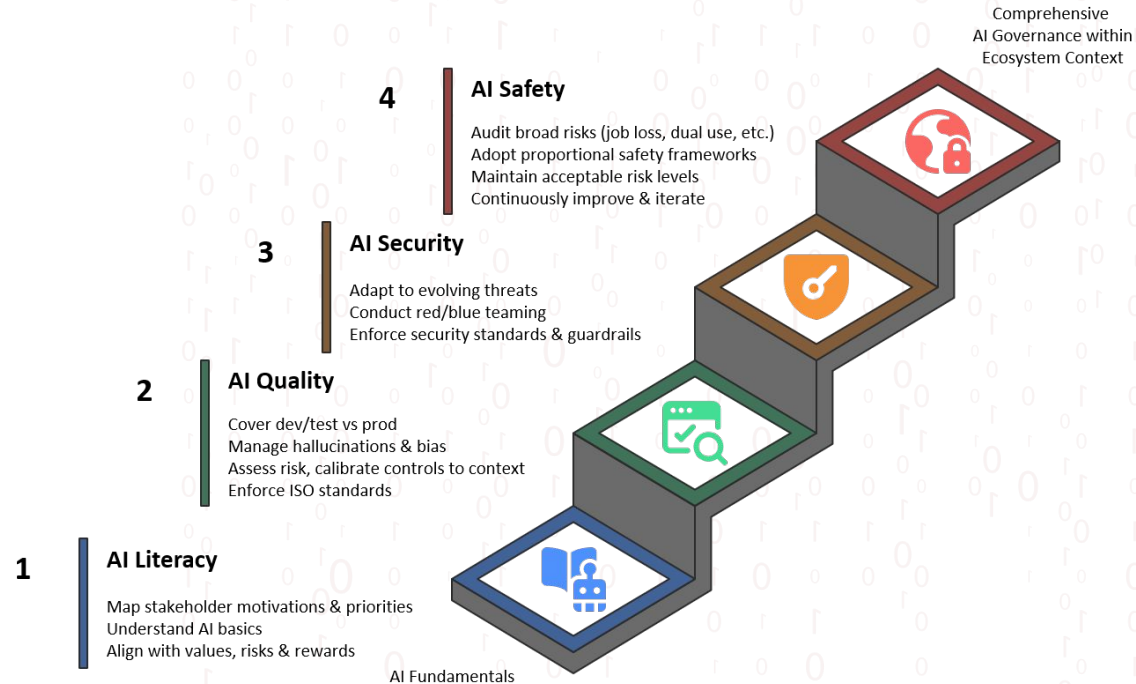
# AI SAFETY INDEX

|                                                                                                                               |  Anthropic |  OpenAI |  Google DeepMind |  Meta |  Z.ai |  Alibaba Cloud |  xAI |  DeepSeek |  Mistral |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall Grade                                                                                                                 | C+                                                                                          | C                                                                                        | C                                                                                                 | D+                                                                                      | D-                                                                                       | D-                                                                                                | F                                                                                       | F                                                                                            | F                                                                                           |
| Score                                                                                                                         | 2.66                                                                                        | 2.28                                                                                     | 2.01                                                                                              | 1.32                                                                                    | 0.88                                                                                     | 0.87                                                                                              | 0.65                                                                                    | 0.47                                                                                         | 0.33                                                                                        |
| Grade Trend (Winter 25)                                                                                                       | C+                                                                                          | C+ ▼                                                                                     | C                                                                                                 | D ▲                                                                                     | D ▼                                                                                      | D-                                                                                                | D ▼                                                                                     | D ▼                                                                                          | N/A                                                                                         |
|  Risk Assessment<br>6 indicators             | C+                                                                                          | C+                                                                                       | C+                                                                                                | D+                                                                                      | F                                                                                        | F                                                                                                 | D-                                                                                      | F                                                                                            | F                                                                                           |
|  Current Harms<br>9 indicators               | B-                                                                                          | C                                                                                        | C                                                                                                 | D-                                                                                      | C-                                                                                       | C-                                                                                                | F                                                                                       | D-                                                                                           | F                                                                                           |
|  Safety Frameworks<br>4 indicators           | B-                                                                                          | C+                                                                                       | C                                                                                                 | C-                                                                                      | D-                                                                                       | D-                                                                                                | D                                                                                       | F                                                                                            | F                                                                                           |
|  Existential Safety<br>4 indicators          | D+                                                                                          | D+                                                                                       | D                                                                                                 | F                                                                                       | F                                                                                        | F                                                                                                 | F                                                                                       | F                                                                                            | F                                                                                           |
|  Governance & Accountability<br>4 indicators | B                                                                                           | C                                                                                        | C-                                                                                                | D+                                                                                      | F                                                                                        | D-                                                                                                | F                                                                                       | F                                                                                            | F                                                                                           |
|  Information Sharing<br>10 indicators        | B+                                                                                          | B-                                                                                       | B-                                                                                                | D+                                                                                      | D                                                                                        | D                                                                                                 | D                                                                                       | D-                                                                                           | D-                                                                                          |
|  Survey Responses                            | ✓                                                                                           | ✓                                                                                        | ✓                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                        | ✗                                                                                                 | ✗                                                                                       | ✗                                                                                            | ✗                                                                                           |

Grading: Uses the US GPA system for grade boundaries: A+, A, A-, B+, [...], F letter values corresponding to numerical values 4.3, 4.0, 3.7, 3.3, [...], 0.

(Image credit: FLI)

## AI Fundamentals → AI Governance



# OUR CORE INITIATIVES:

## MEETUPS & WORKSHOPS

Fostering a vibrant ecosystem by connecting global safety thinking with local UAE & International stakeholders through regular forums (AI Safety Talks) and technical workshops.

## STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

Collaborating with government bodies, regulators, and industry leaders to shape national AI policy and safety standards.

## UPSKILLING

Facilitating deep-dive courses into AI alignment, societal implications, and the ethical deployment of emerging

## HACKATHONS

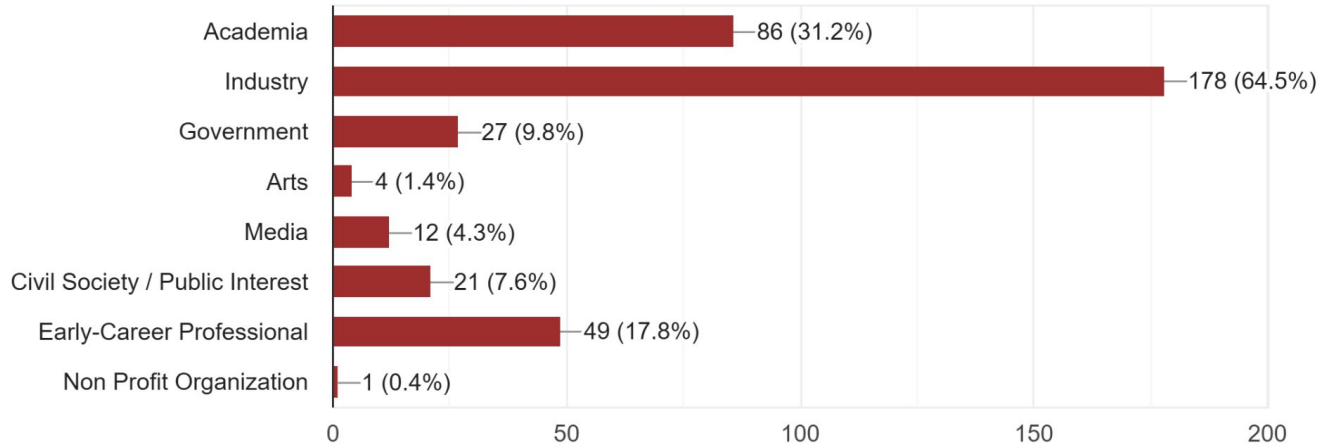
Building scalable, real-world mitigations and safety tools through technical challenges designed for the UAE's developer community.



# MULTI-DISCIPLINARY ECOSYSTEM:

What is your background? (Select one)

276 responses



COMMUNITY-DRIVEN & EXPERT-LED

# MULTI-DISCIPLINARY WORKING GROUPS:

## LITERACY



Driving industry knowledge sharing and professional certifications. We focus on study groups and expert advice to shape AI policy and product safety awareness across the UAE.

## GOVERNANCE & REGULATION



Developing policy frameworks and contributing to national regulatory discussions. We host stakeholder roundtables to ensure public policy is informed by technical safety research.

## TECHNOLOGY & SECURITY



Dedicated to building open-source safety tools and conducting technical research. We mentor builders and advance technical standards for secure AI deployment.

## CONVENING & COORDINATION



Connecting local UAE talent with global AI safety opportunities. We lead communications, outreach, and advocacy to foster international partnerships and civil society engagement.

COMMUNITY-DRIVEN & EXPERT-LED

# CERTIFIED EXPERTISE AND STRATEGIC PARTNERS:

## STRATEGIC PARTNERS



## PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

### ISO 42001 Lead Auditors

Expert-led compliance and auditing for AI Management Systems.

### AIGP Certified Professionals

Internationally recognized AI Governance Professional certification.

## COMPREHENSIVE ENTERPRISE SERVICES:



### 01 / TRAINING

#### FOUNDATIONAL LITERACY

2-hour live sessions building essential AI safety literacy and ethics awareness for non-technical and mixed organizational teams.

### 02 / PROGRAMME

#### ADVANCED SAFETY

Intensive 1-4 week courses covering AI alignment, societal risk, and technical safety for developers and GRC professionals.

### 03 / AUDITING

#### MODEL & VISION AUDITS

Technical model auditing including adversarial attack simulations, jailbreak testing, and comprehensive mitigation reporting.

### 04 / GOVERNANCE

#### RISK FRAMEWORKS

Enterprise AI risk assessment, ISO 42001 compliance, and governance workflow design for board-ready policy recommendations.

# AI POLICY FOR WEALTH, POWER, AND SOVEREIGNTY

AI Everything Abu Dhabi 2026

7th October 2026 | 1:30 – 2:30 PM



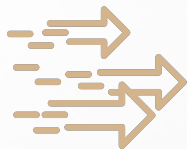
**Naiyarah Hussain**  
**AI Safety UAE, Co-founder**



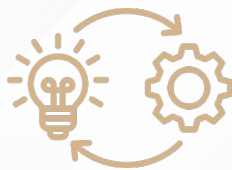
**Melodena Stephens**  
**MBRSG**



# WHY AI POLICY WHY NOW?



**AI capability is  
accelerating**



**AI adoption is  
becoming systemic**



**Governance  
determines who  
carries the risk**

## What would make the UAE truly AI-Native?

Choose one:

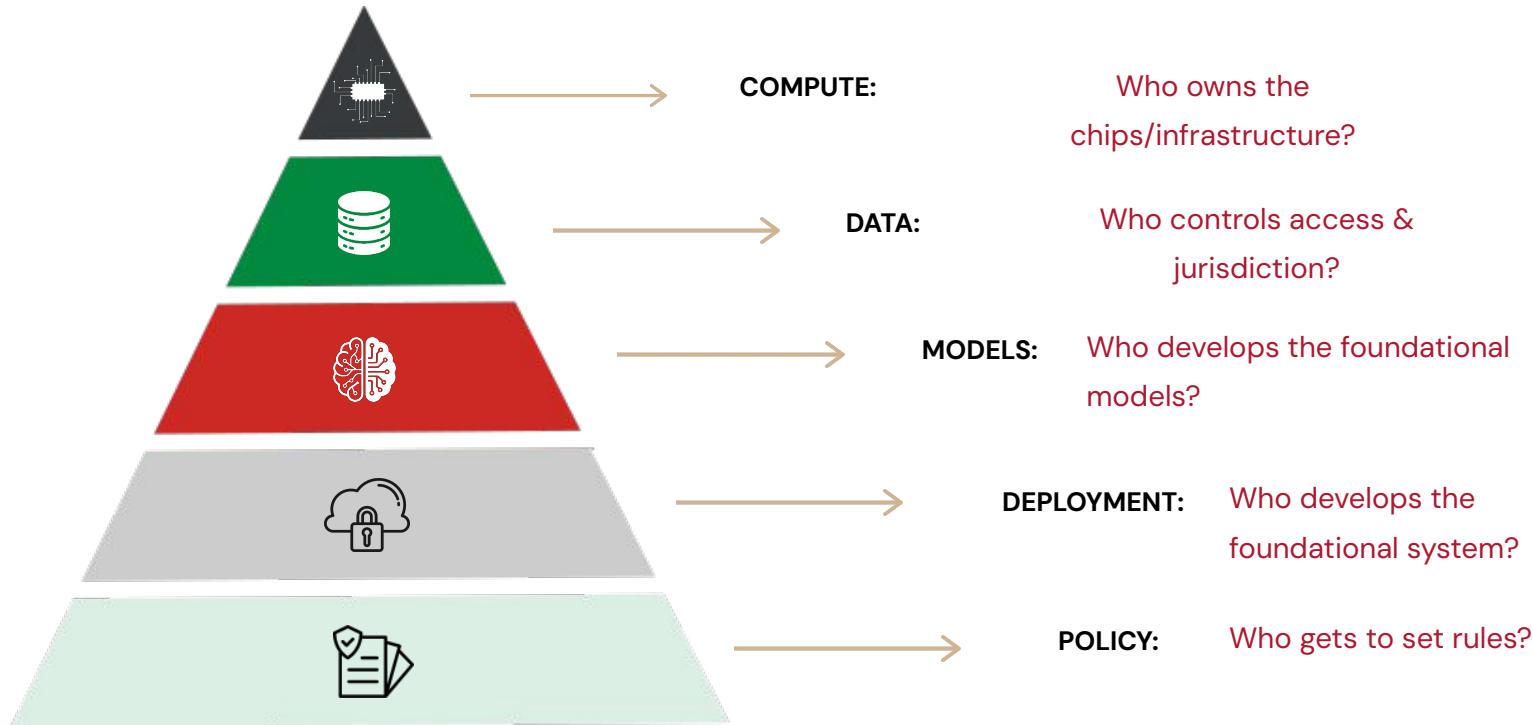
- ☐ **A** | Sovereign compute & infrastructure
- ☐ **B** | Sovereign data
- ☐ **C** | Homegrown AI Models & talent
- ☐ **D** | AI embedded through government



# What would make the UAE truly AI-native?



## THE POWER STACK:



## THE AI POWER STACK:



# CAN YOU BE **AI-NATIVE** WITHOUT OWNING THE FULL STACK?



**Compute**



**Data**



**Algorithms**



**Economic power**



**National security**



**Policy autonomy**

## DIFFERENT COUNTRIES ANSWER THIS QUESTION DIFFERENTLY.



**EU**

Compliance  
approach



**US**

Risk-based  
Oversight



**OECD-NIST**

Ethical  
principles



**G7**

Voluntary  
coordination



**ASEAN**

Regional  
Harmonization



**China**

State  
Directed

## WHO SHOULD HAVE THE POWER TO GOVERN AI?

# POLICY → FRAMEWORK → CONTROLS

## POLICY

Who decides?



- Laws
- Regulations
- International agreements

## FRAMEWORKS

How is it implemented?



- Standards
- Guidelines
- Best practices
- Risk models

## CONTROLS

What happens  
when rules are broken?



- Audits
- Reporting
- Fines
- Restrictions

## AI GOVERNANCE APPROACHES:

**01**

**COMPLIANCE**

EU AI Act

**02**

**RISK**

NIST AI RMF

**03**

**ETHICS**

OECD / IEEE

**04**

**MULTILATERAL**

Hiroshima AI Process

**05**

**HARMONIZED**

ASEAN

**06**

**STATE-DIRECTED**

CHINA

**Different approaches lead to different controls**

## POLICY STANCE

## FRAMEWORK

## CONTROL

|                                                                                               |                |                                      |               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------|---------------|
| EU           | Compliance     | Conformity<br>assessment / fines     | EU AI ACT     |
| NIST         | Risk           | NIST AI RMF                          | AI RMF        |
| OECD / IEEE  | Ethics         | Safety-by-design<br>/human oversight | Principles    |
| CHINA        | State-directed | lifecycle controls /<br>risk grading | Framework 2.0 |

# WHERE DOES **THE UAE** SIT?

## 01

### POLICY / STRATEGIC DIRECTION

Sets the national vision and legal foundation.

- **UAE AI Strategy 2031**  
National ambition for AI adoption, governance and regulation.
- **Federal Decree-Law No. 26 of 2025**  
Child Digital Safety.
- **Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021**  
Personal Data Protection.
- **International engagement**  
Hiroshima AI Process + global AI governance cooperation.

## 02

### FRAMEWORKS / GUIDANCE

Provides direction, standards and sector guidance.

- **CBUAE Responsible A/ML Guidance**  
Consumer protection - accountability transparency - human oversight - third-party risk.
- **UAE Government / Media Office Guidance for GenAI / Agentic AI**  
For government communication teams.
- **Sector & entity-level frameworks**  
Risk frameworks - internal policies - responsible adoption.

## 03

### CONTROLS / IMPLEMENTATION

Turns policy and guidance into practice.

- **Jurisdiction-specific compliance**  
Federal · DIFC · ADGM
- **Extraterritorial obligations**  
Applies to platforms targeting UAE users
- **Platform enforcement**  
Blocking / closure for non-compliance
- **Cybercrime penalties**  
The Federal Decree-Law No. (34) of 2021 On Countering Rumors and Cybercrimes

# WHAT DOES THIS MEAN FOR **THE UAE?**

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-  Who gets to participate in AI governance?
-  Who carries responsibility when AI causes harm?
-  What does sovereignty actually require?



# 01 AI LITERACY

We use words like 'transparency' and 'accountability' constantly, but often define them differently.



## What should 'AI literacy' mean for the UAE?

*What's one practical recommendation for the people in this room to become AI literate?*

## 02 WHOLE-OF-SOCIETY GOVERNANCE

Most AI governance conversations happen among governments, large AI companies and selected regulators.

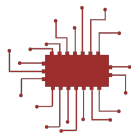


### Who is missing from the room where AI governance decisions are made?

*What would whole-of-society governance look like in practice?*

## 03 DIGITAL SOVEREIGNTY

# Can digital sovereignty exist without owning the full stack?



COMPUTE



DATA



MODELS

*If not, what should the UAE prioritize?*

## 04 INTERNATIONAL COORDINATION

**If a foreign AI provider causes serious harm in the UAE, where should enforcement come from?**

- Local licensing
- Government-to-government cooperation
- Contractual liability
- Something else

## 05 ARABIC & REGIONAL GROUNDING

# What should the UAE build for itself rather than import?

- Multilingual guardrails
- Regional red-teaming
- Cultural alignment

# Which should Abu Dhabi prioritise first in 2027?

Choose one:

A

Enforcement cultural robustness  
mechanisms for AI providers

B

Sovereign compute & data infrastructure

C

Public trust & transparency



# What should Abu Dhabi prioritize first in 2027?



**Thank you for joining us  
today @ AI Policy  
Workshop!**

**Q & A**

**OPEN FLOOR 10–15 MIN**

